

Stop Building Ideas Nobody Wants

The Signal Test Method: A 30-Day Side Hustle Workbook to Test Demand
Before You Build

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Before You Build Anything

Most ideas do not fail because people are lazy.

They fail because nobody tested demand early enough.

This workbook forces you to do the opposite.

In the next 30 days, you will talk to real people, test a real problem, make a tiny offer, and ask for real money.

If nobody pays, you stop or pivot.

If someone pays, you continue.

That is the entire game.

**Most people don't fail because
they're lazy.**

They fail because they never ask anyone if the idea is
worth paying for.

This workbook forces you to ask.

Your First Win (15 Minutes)

Send this message to 1 person today

Hey, quick question — are you still struggling with [problem]?

If they reply, you have your first signal.

Don't overthink it.

Who will you message?

What Counts as a Real Signal?

Real signals

- Someone asks a follow-up question
- Someone shares a real problem
- Someone asks for the price
- Someone says “can you do this for me?”

Not real signals

- “Cool idea”
- “Nice”
- Likes
- Silence

If you cannot tell the difference, you will waste months building the wrong thing.

Workbook Roadmap

The Method

Conversion Tools

Start Here: 15-Minute Tests

Copy/Paste Scripts

Digital Side Hustle Case Study

30-Day Signal Plan

Signal Test Logs

Weekly Reviews

Signal Tracker

Stop / Pivot / Continue Decision

How to Use This Workbook

This workbook is not for collecting ideas. It is for testing whether an idea deserves more time. Each day asks you to take one small action, face the realistic friction, and record what actually happened.

Use this for

This workbook helps you test if people will buy your side hustle idea before you spend time building it, using simple tests over 30 days.

Your notes

The Method

Do not build first. Look for signals first.

Find a real problem

Identify something that genuinely bothers people, costs them time, or frustrates them.

Test: Observe people, listen to complaints, read forums, or ask friends about their frustrations. Focus on pain points that seem common.

What goes wrong: You pick a problem only you have, not one others have. Or you pick a tiny problem no one really cares about enough to pay for.

Stop when: You have 3-5 potential problems that seem significant enough for people to want a solution.

Your notes

Find someone who cares

Locate people who have the problem you identified and are actively looking for a solution or talking about it in public.

Test: Search online forums, social media groups, Reddit, or review sections for people discussing the problem. Look for active conversations.

What goes wrong: You talk to friends or family who are just being nice, not people genuinely affected. You find a group but they aren't actively discussing the problem you care about.

Stop when: You've found 10-15 people openly discussing the problem in public online spaces, ideally within the last few months.

Your notes

Make a tiny offer

Propose a small, quick, and easy solution to part of their problem. This is not your final product, but a test version.

Test: Describe a simple solution in a few sentences and ask if they'd be interested in learning more or trying it. Keep it very simple and low-effort for you to create.

What goes wrong: You make the offer too big or complicated. You sound like a salesperson. People ignore you or say 'maybe later' without real interest.

Stop when: You've described your tiny offer to 5-10 people who have the problem and gotten some initial reaction (even if it's just silence).

Your notes

Ask directly

After making your tiny offer, directly ask if they would pay for it or sign up to try it, moving beyond vague interest.

Test: Use phrases like: 'Would you be interested in paying X for this?' or 'If this existed and solved Y, would you use it regularly?'

What goes wrong: You avoid asking for money or commitment. You get vague 'that sounds good' responses but no real 'yes' or 'no.' People say they like it but won't pull out their wallet.

Stop when: You've directly asked 5-10 people if they would pay or sign up for your tiny offer, getting a clear indication of their intent.

Your notes

Try to get paid

Actually try to collect money or a strong, tangible commitment for your tiny offer to prove real demand.

Test: Set up a simple payment link (e.g., Stripe, PayPal, Gumroad) or a pre-order form and ask them to pay a small amount for the initial version.

What goes wrong: No one buys. People say they don't have time or money right now, or you feel awkward asking for money. Expect low conversion, even from interested parties.

Stop when: You've either collected money from at least one person, or you've made the offer to pay to 5-10 people and received clear 'yes' or 'no' responses (even if 'no' is via silence).

Your notes

Conversion Tools

These tools help you avoid the most common beginner mistake: confusing polite interest with real demand.

The 10-Message Test

Send 10 direct, personal messages before judging an idea. Don't count likes, compliments, or vague interest. Count replies that show pain or willingness to act.

Notes

The \$10 Tiny Offer Test

Turn your idea into one small thing someone could buy for around \$10. If nobody wants the tiny version, don't build the big version yet.

Notes

The Polite Interest Trap

People saying 'cool idea' is not demand. Demand looks like questions, urgency, payment, referrals, or asking when it's available.

Notes

The Silence Rule

If people ignore the offer after multiple direct asks, treat silence as data. Don't argue with the market.

Notes

The 3-Signal Scorecard

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Start Here: 15-Minute Tests

Find 3 frustrating things

List 3 things that annoyed you or someone you know this week. Don't censor yourself. Think about small daily pains.

Your notes

Join a relevant online group

Find one active online forum, Reddit community, or Facebook group where people discuss a problem you're interested in. Just join, don't post yet.

Your notes

Ask one person about their day

Have a 5-minute conversation with a friend or colleague, focusing on what's hard or annoying for them at work or home. Just listen, don't offer solutions.

Your notes

Copy/Paste Scripts

Use these as starting points. Rewrite them so they sound like you.

Problem Discovery Hook

Hey, I've noticed [problem] often comes up when people try to [goal]. Is that something you've struggled with too?

Notes

Solution Idea Share

I've been thinking about a simple way to deal with [problem]. What if there was a [tiny offer description, e.g., 'checklist for this step']? Do you think that would actually help you?

Notes

Direct Interest Check

Based on what you've said about [problem], I'm thinking of creating a [tiny offer product type] to fix it. If I did, would you be genuinely interested in checking it out or trying it?

Notes

Price Probe

If this [tiny offer product type] could genuinely save you [time/money/frustration], what would you consider a fair price for it? No commitment, just curious.

Notes

Commitment Ask

If I built this [tiny offer product type] for [small price], would you be willing to be one of the first to try it and give me feedback? I'm only making a few initial spots.

Notes

Pre-Payment Request

I'm putting together the first version of the [tiny offer product type]. I'm taking a few pre-orders for just [small price] to cover early costs and get early feedback. Would you like to secure one of the first copies now?

Notes

Digital Side Hustle Case Study: The Freelance Budgeting Spreadsheet

Idea

A simple Google Sheet template to help freelance writers track income, expenses, and set aside money for taxes.

What I did

Joined freelance writer forums and Facebook groups. Searched for keywords like ‘freelance budget,’ ‘tax tracker,’ ‘expense headache’ to find complaints. Observed many writers expressing stress about budgeting and tax season. Posted a question: ‘Hey freelancers, what’s your biggest headache with money tracking and taxes?’ After some replies, I offered: ‘I’m thinking of creating a super simple Google Sheet that handles income, expenses, and tells you what to put aside for taxes. Would anyone be interested in seeing a demo or getting a copy for \$7?’ Built a basic (ugly) sheet to fulfill the promise. Followed up with 5 people who showed initial interest and shared a link to a simple Gumroad product for \$7.

What happened

The initial forum post got 3 replies. Two were just ‘yeah that sounds good.’ One was a detailed complaint about using multiple tools. When I offered the \$7 spreadsheet, 2 people clicked the link, but nobody bought it. One person asked if it integrated with their bank (it didn’t). I felt awkward asking for money for something so basic.

What I learned

There was some general interest in budgeting help for freelancers, but a basic, non-integrated spreadsheet might not be enough to solve their specific pain points. The \$7 price point might have been too low to signal serious value, or too high for such a simple tool without more proof of its benefit. My offer was probably too vague and didn’t clearly address a single, acute pain point.

Nobody bought the first version. That was the signal. Not failure.

What I would do differently

Focus on a more specific pain point, e.g., ‘tracking quarterly estimated taxes’ instead of general budgeting. Instead of \$7 for a sheet, perhaps offer a ‘mini-audit’ or a more personalized template for \$25, or a free basic version to hook people before an upgrade. Engage more deeply in problem discovery before jumping to an offer. Get specific about the exact problem my spreadsheet would solve, not just ‘budgeting’.

Your notes

30-Day Signal Plan

Each day has one action, one reality check, and one win condition. Complete the action before reading ahead.

Day 1: Brainstorm your frustrations

Action

List 5 things that annoy you or waste your time on a regular basis. Think about work, hobbies, or daily life. No idea is too small.

Reality

It's hard to think of things beyond 'my alarm clock.' Don't worry if they seem trivial now.

Win condition

You have a list of at least 5 frustrations, written down.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 2: Look for others' pain

Action

Go to Reddit, Facebook groups, or online forums related to your interests. Spend 30 minutes reading posts and comments, specifically looking for complaints.

Reality

You might just scroll for 30 minutes without finding anything obvious. That's okay, you're learning what's not a strong signal.

Win condition

You've identified one potential problem discussed by others, or noted that no clear problems emerged in that time.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 3: Pick your top 3 problems

Action

From your lists (Day 1 & 2), choose 3 problems that seem most common or most painful for people. Don't overthink it.

Reality

All problems might feel equally important or unimportant. Just pick the ones that feel 'heaviest' or most often mentioned.

Win condition

You have 3 clear problem statements, each 1-2 sentences long.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 4: Research where these people hang out

Action

For each of your 3 problems, list 2-3 specific online communities (forums, groups, subreddits) where people discuss them. Be specific.

Reality

Some problems might not have dedicated online spaces. You might need to broaden your search to related communities.

Win condition

You have at least one active online community identified for each of your top 3 problems.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 5: Dive deep into one community

Action

Pick one problem and one community. Spend 60 minutes actively reading posts, looking for patterns, specific frustrations, and the exact language people use to describe their problem.

Reality

You might get sidetracked or overwhelmed by the sheer volume of posts. Focus on using search terms related to your problem within the community.

Win condition

You've identified 3-5 specific complaints or questions related to your chosen problem within that community.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 6: Craft a clear problem statement

Action

Based on your research, write a 1-2 sentence statement that clearly describes ONE problem you've observed in detail, using the language of your target audience.

Reality

It might feel too vague or too specific. Keep revising until it feels clear and true to what you heard.

Win condition

You have one concise problem statement that feels accurate to your research.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 7: Identify your target person

Action

Describe the ideal person who experiences this problem. What do they do? What are their goals? What are they trying to avoid? What's their current workaround?

Reality

You might only have a vague idea. That's fine for now, just try to sketch them out with what you know.

Win condition

You have a short description of your target person, including their goals and current struggles.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 8: Draft a problem-focused post

Action

Write a post for your chosen online community asking about the problem. Don't offer solutions yet. Just ask open-ended questions. (See Script 1)

Reality

You might feel self-conscious or worry no one will reply. This is normal. Focus on being genuinely curious.

Win condition

You have a draft post ready to go, focused solely on the problem.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 9: Post your problem question

Action

Publish your draft post in the community you chose. Be genuine and conversational.

Reality

You might get no replies or only one-word answers. This is normal. It's a signal.

Win condition

Your post is live in the target community.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 10: Analyze responses

Action

Review any replies to your post. Look for common themes, strong emotions, specific examples of the problem, and how many people responded. Note low replies.

Reality

Low replies can be discouraging. If you get none, it's a signal to move on to a different problem or rephrase your question for next time.

Win condition

You've read and noted down insights from replies, even if few or negative.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 11: Brainstorm tiny solutions

Action

For your chosen problem, list 3-5 **very small** and **easy to create** solutions. Think checklists, simple templates, short guides, or a mini-audit. Keep it minimal.

Reality

Your mind might jump to big, complex ideas. Force yourself to think tiny. What's the absolute minimum you could offer?

Win condition

You have 3-5 distinct ideas for tiny offers, each easily explainable.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 12: Pick your best tiny offer

Action

Choose the one tiny offer that seems easiest for you to make and most directly addresses a pain point you've identified. Don't dwell on it.

Reality

You might second-guess your choice or feel none are good enough. Just pick one and commit to testing it for now.

Win condition

You have one specific tiny offer concept selected for testing.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 13: Describe your tiny offer

Action

Write 2-3 sentences describing your tiny offer. Focus on the direct benefit it provides to the user, not just its features. (See Script 2)

Reality

It's hard to make it sound appealing without sounding like a salesperson. Keep it simple, direct, and focused on solving the user's problem.

Win condition

You have a clear, benefit-oriented description of your tiny offer.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 14: Share your tiny offer idea with 2 people

Action

Find 2 people (not close friends/family) from your target community or network who might have the problem. Share your tiny offer idea with them. Ask for their initial reaction.

Reality

They might be polite but uninterested, or not respond at all. This is part of the test; silence is a signal.

Win condition

You've shared your tiny offer idea with 2 people and noted their reactions.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 15: Ask for interest (without asking for money)

Action

Follow up with those 2 people, or find 2 new ones. Use Script 3 ('Direct Interest Check') to gauge their interest. Focus on getting a clear 'yes' or 'no.'

Reality

They might give vague 'sounds good' answers without real commitment. Push gently for clarity on whether they'd 'actually use it.'

Win condition

You've directly asked 2 people if they'd be interested in your tiny offer and gotten some kind of direct response.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 16: Refine your tiny offer based on feedback

Action

If you got any clear feedback (even just ‘not interested in X feature’), adjust your tiny offer description slightly to better match needs.

Reality

You might not have much clear feedback to work with, which itself is a signal. Make an educated guess or keep it as is.

Win condition

You’ve considered and made any necessary tweaks to your tiny offer description, or confirmed no changes needed based on lack of specific feedback.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 17: Repeat interest check with 3 more people

Action

Use your refined offer description and Script 3. Share with 3 new people from your target audience. Try to find people who haven't heard your pitch before.

Reality

The rejections or silence can feel personal. Remember, it's about the idea and the market, not you personally. Keep tracking responses.

Win condition

You've engaged 3 new people with your tiny offer idea and recorded their responses.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 18: Introduce the idea of value/price

Action

With people who showed *some* interest, use Script 4 ('Price Probe'). Ask what they'd consider a fair price for the solution, or what it would be worth to them.

Reality

They might give you a range, or say 'I don't know.' Push gently for a number they'd be comfortable paying for such a solution.

Win condition

You've asked 2-3 people about their perceived value/price for your tiny offer.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 19: Set a small, specific price

Action

Based on your offer and any price feedback, decide on a *small* price for your tiny offer. Think \$5-\$25. It should feel low-risk for a buyer.

Reality

It's hard to put a price on something you haven't fully built. Pick a number that feels like a low-risk test for both you and the potential buyer.

Win condition

You have a specific, concrete price for your tiny offer.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 20: Create a simple landing page or offer description

Action

Create a super basic page (e.g., a simple Gumroad product page, a Google Doc, or even just a detailed post) that describes your tiny offer and states its price. No payment link yet, just the details.

Reality

You might procrastinate on this, thinking it needs to be perfect. It doesn't. It just needs to be clear and functional.

Win condition

You have a simple page/post detailing your offer and price, ready to share.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 21: Ask for commitment (without payment)

Action

Using Script 5 ('Commitment Ask'), share your landing page/description with 3 people who showed interest. Ask if they'd commit to buying if it were ready.

Reality

People will say 'yes' more easily if there's no money involved. Pay close attention to how enthusiastic they sound, not just a polite agreement.

Win condition

You've shared your offer and asked for commitment from 3 people, noting their responses.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 22: Review commitment responses

Action

Note down who committed and what their reasons were. Are they just being nice? Or genuinely excited and specific about how it helps them?

Reality

It's easy to read too much into positive responses. Look for concrete language and enthusiasm, not just polite agreement.

Win condition

You have a clear understanding of commitments received and their perceived quality.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 23: Prepare a payment link

Action

Set up a simple way to collect money for your tiny offer (e.g., Gumroad product, Stripe link, PayPal button). Test it to make sure it works.

Reality

This might feel like a big, scary step. Keep it simple and functional. The goal is just to make it possible for someone to pay.

Win condition

You have a working payment link for your tiny offer.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 24: Make the pre-payment request

Action

Contact 2-3 people who showed *strong* interest/commitment and use Script 6 ('Pre-Payment Request'). Share your payment link directly.

Reality

This is often where people disappear. Be prepared for silence, excuses, or awkwardness. This is valuable data.

Win condition

You've sent your payment link to 2-3 people who previously expressed strong interest.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 25: Handle first responses to payment request

Action

Observe if anyone buys. If not, reflect on any direct feedback (e.g., 'I need more detail,' 'price too high,' 'not right now').

Reality

No sales is a strong signal. Don't be discouraged; it's just information telling you to adjust or try a new path.

Win condition

You've documented responses (or lack thereof) to your payment request and any feedback received.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 26: Follow up (gently) with non-buyers

Action

If no one bought, send a very polite follow-up to one person who didn't. 'Just checking in, was there anything unclear about the offer, or was it simply not a good fit right now?'

Reality

They might still not respond, or give a vague answer. This is still helpful data, confirming low interest or poor offer clarity.

Win condition

You've sent a gentle follow-up to at least one non-buyer to gather more information.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 27: Identify clear ‘yes’ or ‘no’ signals

Action

Review all your interactions: direct asks, commitments, payment attempts. Who clearly said ‘yes’ (with money or strong intent)? Who clearly said ‘no’ (or ghosted)? Who is in the grey area?

Reality

Most responses will be in the grey area. Try to categorize them as best you can to see patterns.

Win condition

You have a clear tally of strong ‘yes,’ strong ‘no,’ and ‘maybe’ signals.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 28: Decide: Build, Refine, or Kill

Action

Based on your signals: Did you get paid? Did many people strongly commit? Did everyone ignore you? Decide if you should build the full product, refine the offer/problem, or kill the idea and move on.

Reality

It's hard to let go of an idea. Be honest with yourself about the signals, even if they're not what you hoped for.

Win condition

You've made a preliminary decision: Build, Refine, or Kill this specific idea.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 29: Plan your next step

Action

If you decided to Build, outline the very next **small** step (e.g., build v1 of X feature). If Refine, what specifically will you change about the offer, problem, or audience? If Kill, what new problem will you explore from your Day 3 list?

Reality

The temptation is to jump to a new idea immediately without learning. Stick to a concrete next step for this idea or a new, **first** step for the next one.

Win condition

You have a clear, actionable plan for your next step, regardless of the 'Build, Refine, or Kill' decision.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Day 30: Celebrate your learning

Action

Whether you got a sale or not, you've learned something crucial about market demand. Acknowledge the effort and data collected. You didn't waste months building something nobody wanted, and that's a huge win.

Reality

You might feel disappointed if you didn't get a sale. Reframe it as saving yourself a lot of wasted time and money, which is a powerful outcome.

Win condition

You've recognized your effort and learning, regardless of the outcome, and are ready for the next test.

You're not looking for motivation. You're looking for proof.

Daily notes

What happened today? What signal did you see? What is the next smallest action?

Notes

Signal Test Logs

Use these pages for extra tests, repeated asks, new audiences, and price checks.

Signal Test Log 1

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 2

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 3

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 4

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 5

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 6

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 7

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 8

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 9

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 10

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 11

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Signal Test Log 12

Idea being tested

Write the specific idea, offer, or angle you're testing.

Your notes

Audience

Who exactly did you test this with?

Notes

Ask made

What did you ask them to do, answer, or pay for?

Notes

Signal received

What actually happened? Don't count hope. Count behavior.

Your notes

Extra Scorecards

Use one scorecard per idea, audience, or offer version.

Scorecard 1

3-Signal Scorecard 1

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 2

3-Signal Scorecard 2

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 3

3-Signal Scorecard 3

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 4

3-Signal Scorecard 4

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 5

3-Signal Scorecard 5

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 6

3-Signal Scorecard 6

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 7

3-Signal Scorecard 7

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Scorecard 8

3-Signal Scorecard 8

Problem strength (1-5):

Reachability (1-5):

Willingness to pay (1-5):

Total score:

Interpretation 3-7: Stop

8-11: Pivot

12-15: Continue

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Write the reason.

Notes

Weekly Reviews

These pages help you avoid confusing motion with progress.

Weekly Review 1

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes

Weekly Review 2

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes

Weekly Review 3

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes

Weekly Review 4

Strongest signal this week

What was the clearest sign that someone cared?

Your notes

Weakest signal this week

Where did you get silence, vague praise, or polite interest?

Notes

What changed

What did you change because of real feedback?

Notes

Decision

Stop, pivot, or continue? Why?

Your notes

Price Test Notes

Price Test 1

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 2

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 3

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Price Test 4

What price did you ask for? Who did you ask? What happened?

Your notes

Signal Tracker

[illegible]

Stop / Pivot / Continue

Continue

What created a real signal: payment, specific request, repeated problem, urgency, or a direct yes?

Your notes

Pivot

What part seemed promising, but needs a different audience, offer, price, or message?

Notes

Stop

What produced silence, vague compliments, weak signals, or polite interest without action?

Notes

Next \$10 Test

What is the smallest paid test you'll run next?

Your notes

Final Notes

What I learned about the market

What did real people show you?

Notes

What I learned about myself

What did you avoid, overthink, or discover?

Notes
